

Team: Keyboard Gremlins

COS301 Capstone Project
University of Pretoria

Hackathon Platform



Brand Style Guide

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Table of Contents

1.Purpose.....	4
2.Colour Palette.....	5
Primary Palette.....	5
Neutrals.....	6
Semantic Colours.....	6
WCAG 2.2 Contrast Ratios.....	6
3.Typography System.....	7
Primary Font.....	7
Fallback.....	7
Font Weights.....	7
Typography Scale.....	7
4.Logo & Iconography.....	8
Logo Variations.....	8
Minimum Size Rules.....	8
5.Design Tokens.....	9
Spacing Scale.....	9
Border Radius.....	9
Shadows.....	10
Motion Tokens.....	10
Breakpoints.....	10
6.Component Library.....	11
Button Variants.....	11
Button Sizes.....	11
Button States.....	12
Input States.....	12
Modal.....	13
Toast Notifications.....	13
Badge Variants.....	14
7.Layout & Spacing.....	14
Grid System - 12-Column Grid.....	14
Content Widths.....	14
Spacing Scale Application.....	15
Responsive Adjustments.....	15
8. Accessibility Standards.....	16
Conformance Target.....	16

Focus Indicators.....	16
Screen Reader Considerations.....	16
Motion Reduction.....	17
Automate Audit Scores.....	17
9. Voice & Tone.....	17
Writing Principles.....	17
UI Copy Examples.....	17
10. Changelog from Demo 1.....	18

1. Purpose

This guide sets out the visual language of the Hackathon Platform: the colours, typography, and the logo treatment that are already implemented across the admin and participant's portal. Its purpose is to ensure that every screen developed from this point remains visually consistent, and that new or returning team members are able to understand the platform's styling conventions without needing to examine individual components.

The interface is governed by three principles to stay consistent:

- Blue is the primary interactive colour. It should be the default choice for buttons, links, active navigation states, and any other clickable element.
- Lime is the brand accent rather than a general-purpose UI colour. Its use is reserved for the logo mark, the "Admin" or "Participant" role pill, and other deliberate brand moments, so that it continues to signal "brand" rather than "button".
- Green and red are strictly for status indication, denoting success or active states and error or destructive actions respectively. Neither colour is used decoratively.

Every colour, font size and logo rule documented in this guide has been drawn directly from the component styles. This document is intended to reflect the implementation at all times; where a discrepancy arises. This guide should be revised to reflect an approved change.

2.Colour Palette

The palette below has been drawn directly from the SCSS files across all components. Colours are grouped by functional role rather than by hue, as this reflects how they are actually applied within the application.

Primary Palette



Name	RGB	HSL	Usage
Navy Darkest	rgb(19,25,45)	hsl (228,41%,13%)	Backgrounds, text
Navy Deep	rgb(6,41,81)	hsl (212,86%,17%)	Navigation, sub-navigation
Primary Blue	rgb(25,131,194)	hsl (202, 77%, 43%)	Primary actions, links
Teal	rgb(1,142,154)	hsl (185 , 99%, 30%)	Avatars, accents
Green	rgb(38,139,66)	hsl (136 , 57%, 35%)	Success, positive actions
Lime Accent	rgb(161,191,36)	hsl (71, 68%, 45%)	Badges, highlights

Neutrals



Semantic Colours

Name	HEX	Usage
Success	#268B42	Success messages, completed status
Warning	#D4690F	Warnings, caution
Error	#C0392B	Errors, destructive actions
Info	#1983C2	Informational messages

WCAG 2.2 Contrast Ratios

Foreground	Background	Ratio	Compliance
#13192D	#FFFFFF	17.3:1	AAA
#3A4357	#FFFFFF	11.2:1	AAA
#1983C2	#FFFFFF	5.8:1	AA
#268B42	#FFFFFF	6.2:1	AAA
#FFFFFF	#13192D	17.3:1	AAA
#FFFFFF	#062951	14.5:1	AAA

3. Typography System

Primary Font : Inter

Fallback: -apple-system, BlinkMacSystemFont, 'Segoe UI', Roboto, sans-serif

The primary typeface is Inter, with -apple-system and sans-serif specified as fallbacks. It is the only font family declared anywhere within the admin portal, and is applied consistently across all components. This consistency should be preserved as new pages are introduced.

Font Weights

Name	Value	Usage
Regular	400	Body text, captions
Medium	500	Labels, sub-headings
Semibold	600	Buttons, strong emphasis
Bold	700	Headings, display text

Typography Scale

Name	Size (rem)	Size (px)	Weight	Line Height	Usage
Display	3.5rem	56px	700	1.1	Hero section, Large titles
H1	2.5rem	40px	700	1.2	Page headers
H2	1.75rem	28px	700	1.3	Section headings
H3	1.25rem	20px	600	1.4	Card titles, sub-headings
Body Large	1.125rem	18px	400	1.6	Lead text, descriptions
Body	1rem	16px	400	1.5	Main body

					text
Small	0.875rem	14px	400	1.5	Labels, meta text
Caption	0.75rem	12px	400	1.5	Captions, helper text

4. Logo & Iconography

Logo Variations

Variation	Usage
Full Logo	Primary usage on light backgrounds
Monogram (H)	Favicon, app icon, compact spaces
Monochrome	Print, grayscale, or dark mode
Inverse	Dark backgrounds

Minimum Size Rules

Variation	Minimum Size
Full Logo	120px width
Monogram	32px width
Favicon	16px x 16px

5.Design Tokens

Spacing Scale (Base: 4px)

Token	Value	Usage
space-0	0	No spacing
space-1	4px	Tight spacing
space-2	8px	Small gaps
space-3	12px	Medium gaps
space-4	16px	Standard gaps
space-6	24px	Large gaps
space-8	32px	Section spacing
space-12	48px	Page spacing

Border Radius

Token	Value	Usage
radius-sm	4px	Inputs, small elements
radius-md	8px	Buttons, cards, badges
radius-lg	12px	Cards, modals
radius-xl	16px	Modals, panels
radius-full	9999px	Pills, avatars

Shadows

Token	Value	Usage
Shadow-sm	0 1px 2px rgba(19,25,45,0.04)	Subtle depth
Shadow-md	0 1px 2px rgba(6,41,81,0.15)	Buttons
Shadow-lg	0 1px 2px rgba(19,25,45,0.08)	Cards on hover
Shadow-xl	0 1px 2px rgba(6,41,81,0.25)	Modals, overlays

Motion Tokens

Token	Value	Usage
duration-fast	150ms	Micro-interactions, hover
duration-normal	250ms	Transitions, fade
duration-slow	400ms	Page transitions, modals
easing-standard	cubic-bezier(0.2 , 0, 0.1)	Default easing
easing-enter	cubic-bezier(0 , 0, 0.2, 0.1)	Entrance animation
easing-exit	cubic-bezier(0.4 , 0, 1,1)	Exit animation

Breakpoints

Token	Value	Usage
mobile	0-767px	Phones
tablet	768-1023px	Tablets
desktop	1024-1439px	Laptops
wide	1440px+	Large Screens

6.Component Library

Button Variants



Variant	Background	Text	Border	Usage
Primary	#1983C2	#FFFFFF	None	Primary actions
Secondary	Transparent	#1983C2	2px solid #1983C2	Secondary actions
Ghost	Transparent	#1983C2	None	Tertiary actions
Success	#268B42	#FFFFFF	None	Positive actions
Danger	#C0392B	#FFFFFF	None	Destructive actions

Button Sizes

Size	Padding	Font Size
Small	6px 14px	0.75rem
Medium	10px 24px	0.875rem
Large	14px 32px	1rem

Button States

Default → Hover → Active → Focus → Disabled → Loading

```
btn-primary {  
  background-color: #1983C2;  
  color: #FFFFFF;  
  border: none;  
  border-radius: 8px;  
  padding: 10px 24px;  
  font-size: 0.875rem;  
  font-weight: 600;  
  cursor: pointer;  
  transition: background-color 0.15s, transform 0.1s;  
}  
  
.btn-primary:hover {  
  background-color: #146A9D; }  
.btn-primary:active { transform: translateY(1px); }  
.btn-primary:focus { outline: 2px solid #1983C2; outline-offset: 2px; }  
.btn-primary:disabled { opacity: 0.6; cursor: not-allowed; }
```

Input States

Default → Focus → Error → Disabled

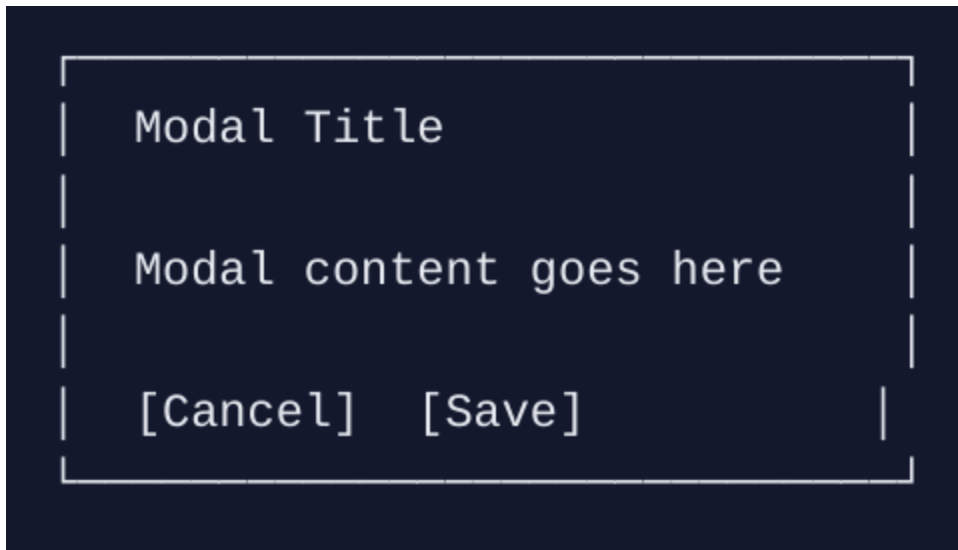
```
.input {  
  width: 100% ;  
  padding: 10px 14px;  
  border: 1.5px solid #DFE3EA;  
  border-radius: 8px;  
  background-color: #F9FAFC;  
  color: #13192D;  
  font-size: 0.9rem;  
  font-family: inherit;  
  outline: none;
```

```

transition: border-color 0.15s,
background-color 0.15s; }
.input:focus { border-color: #1983C2; background-color: #FFFFFF; }
.input.error { border-color: #C0392B; }

```

Modal



Overlay : `rgba( 13, 20 , 38, 0.55 )` with backdrop blur 4px

Toast Notifications

Variant	Icon	Border Left
Success	✓	#268B42
Error	✗	#C0392B
Warning	⚠	#D4690F
Info	i	#1983C2

Badge Variants

Active

Upcoming

Completed

Ended

Variant	Icon	Border Left
Active	rgba(38,139,66,0.12)	#268B42
Upcoming	rgba(25,131,194,0.12)	#1983C2
Completed	rgba(107,117,136,0.12)	#6B7588
Ended	rgba(192,57,43,0.12)	#C0392B

7.Layout & Spacing

Grid System - 12-Column Grid

Screen Size	Columns	Gutter
Mobile	4	16px
Tablet	8	16px
Desktop	12	20px
Wide	12	20px

Content Widths

Context	Max Width
Dashboard	1100px
Forms	720px

Details	980px
Full Width	100%

Spacing Scale Application

Element	Spacing
Page padding	32px 28px(desktop)
Card padding	24px
Section margin	28px
Form group margin	16px
Button gap	12px

Responsive Adjustments

Device	Page Padding	Card Padding
Desktop	32px 28px	24px
Tablet	24px 20px	20px
Mobile	16px	16px

8. Accessibility Standards

Conformance Target

WCAG 2.2 AA minimum, AAA encouraged for body text.

Focus Indicators

```
:focus-visible {  
  
outline: 2px solid #1983C2;  
  
outline-offset: 2px; }
```

Screen Reader Considerations

- All images have appropriate alt text
- Form fields have associated <label>
- ARIA landmarks: navigation, main, complementary
- Aria-label for icon-only buttons
- aria-busy="true" during loading states
- role="status" for dynamic messages

Motion Reduction

```
@media (prefers-reduced-motion: reduce) {  
  * {  
    animation-duration: 0.01ms !important;  
    transition-duration: 0.01ms !important;  
  }  
}
```

Automate Audit Scores

Tool	Score
Lighthouse Accessibility	>= 95
Axe DevTools	All checks pass
WAVE	No errors

9. Voice & Tone

Writing Principles

- Be Clear
- Be Brief (delete unnecessary words)
- Be Human
- Be Helpful
-

UI Copy Examples

Button Labels

Use action verbs: "Create Event", "Save Changes", "Delete Hackathon"

Avoid generic: "Submit", "Ok", "Confirm"

10. Changelog from Demo 1

Area	Demo 1	Demo 2	Rationale
Navigation	Event list, Solver in top nav	Hackathons as central hub	Better user flow, hackathons are the primary entity
Colours	Basic palette	WCAG 2.2 compliant palette	Accessibility requirements
Typography	System fonts	Inter from Google Fonts	Better readability, more refined
Buttons	Three variants	Five variants with sizes	More flexibility, consistent patterns
Hackathons	No present	Full CRUD with grid cards	Client Requirements, central feature
Dates	Required fields	Removed from hackathon creation	Simplification based on user feedback
Back navigation	None	Consistent across all pages	Improved UX flow
Accessibility	Basic consideration	WCAG 2.2 AA target	Mandatory requirement